How the Americas Hear the Church: *Doctrina Social Católica* y Evangelización en los Medios Electrónicos

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Abstract

Public discourse on religion across the Americas runs through news, television, streaming, radio, and online video [3]. Latin American audiences spend nearly double the global average on online news, so analysis needs a hemispheric, not U.S., snapshot [2]. Current approaches often rely on U.S. English sources or official Church documents, overlooking the regional vocabulary and networks through which Catholicism is communicated in media. That gap matters for formation: inquirers in OCIA and parish short courses often first meet the Church in news and digital media before class, yet educators lack shareable text on what themes circulate beforehand.

We present *Catholic Media of the Americas* (2015 to Q2 2026) as **educational infrastructure** for how the Church is proclaimed. Parallel English, Spanish, and Portuguese lexicons collect news, television, radio, and video across the Americas [11, 9, 10, 7, 1, 5], joining core terms (*catholic*, *católico*, *evangelização*), papal names from Leo XIII, and Catholic social teaching titles from *Rerum Novarum* through *Magnifica Humanitas*. We ask: **How do Catholic themes and social teachings circulate across countries and languages, and what regional patterns emerge in the media through which people encounter Catholicism?** The pipeline is **Safe** and **Responsible**: NER and regex redaction strip personally identifiable information before release [6, 4]. It is **Empowering** and **Inclusive**: the first large-scale de-identified corpus on Catholic media across the Americas [8, 12], spanning multiple languages and countries on one shared denominator.

We find that Catholic media discourse reflects distinct regional traditions and priorities rather than a single hemispheric Catholic register. Scale makes that claim concrete: 522,309 geolocated unique-event news rows share one denominator, including 67,724 outside the United States (4,994 in Chile). Fetch coverage skews north: UN developing countries are 9.7% of geolocated news, yet once read, Catholic themes run denser in Latin America than U.S. baselines suggest. Fisher's exact tests (Holm-adjusted) compare theme hits against U.S. news. A quadratic-assignment permutation of the country×teaching graph ($r = 0.38$, $p < 0.001$) matches a pre-specified map and provides a research backbone; first written mention follows that map in 6/6 topics ($p = 0.006$). Brazil shows substantially greater attention to *Aparecida* and CELAM, Central America to *Óscar Romero*, and Mexico to *Guadalupe* and migration. Spanish-language media also favors terms such as *evangelio* and *misión* over the English-language vocabulary and canonical titles that dominate U.S. sources.

Transmission and timing differ too. *Aparecida* reaches Chile 16 days after the United States, so themes that dominate U.S. English wire copy can arrive before local registers take shape. Radio *La Retaguardia* (2021) illustrates the difference in spoken form: "Opción por los Pobres. . . frente al hambre y la desigualdad social."

For educators, the corpus shows **which Catholic themes circulate in media before formal instruction and how those themes differ across cultural contexts**. By making regional and linguistic patterns visible on one shared denominator, it offers a more representative foundation for OCIA, parish short courses, and classroom materials that reflect the Catholic discourse people already encounter.

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